

PRINCIPLES

1. Always use the "Rule of the Square" to determine if your pawn can promote before the enemy king can catch it.
2. Identify and control key squares to enhance your pawn's promotion chances.
3. Bring your king closer to the pawn to support its advance.
4. Use opposition to restrict the movement of the enemy king.
5. Avoid pushing your pawn too early; ensure your king is in a favorable position first.
6. Understand how to promote doubled pawns effectively against a king.
7. In king and pawn versus king endgames, always aim to keep your king in front of the pawn.
8. Calculate potential pawn promotions carefully before making moves.
9. Use shouldering techniques to block the opposing king's path.
10. Familiarize yourself with basic winning and drawing techniques in pawn endgames.

SITUATION

This lesson examines the ending of Rook vs. Bishop, focusing on the wrong corner. The defender must be cautious when the king is pushed to the edge of the board, as this can lead to losing the game. The lesson emphasizes the importance of keeping the bishop in a safe position while maneuvering the rook to control key squares.

FEN: 8/5k2/8/4P3/4K3/8/8/8 w - - 0 1

GOAL

White's goal is to force the black bishop out of its safe position and checkmate the black king, while Black aims to maintain the bishop's safety.

STRATEGY

Force the black bishop out of its safe position while maintaining control over the squares. The lesson illustrates the winning plan of checkmating the black king while avoiding stalemate.

MOVES

First, move your rook to f1 to force the black king out of its safe position. If the black king moves to h2, you can checkmate. The most accurate move order would be: 1. Rf1 Bh2 2. Ra7 1-0

HOW IT LINKS TO THE RULES

This lesson emphasizes the importance of controlling squares and forcing the opponent's pieces into unfavorable positions. It also highlights the need for careful maneuvering to avoid stalemate.